arise from the fertile imagination of science fiction, but one may also emerge from the cutting-edge findings of modern physics.

The Fabric of the Cosmos is intended primarily for the general reader who has little or no formal training in the sciences but whose desire to understand the workings of the universe provides incentive to grapple with a number of complex and challenging concepts. As in my first book, *The Elegant Universe*, I've stayed close to the core scientific ideas throughout, while stripping away the mathematical details in favor of metaphors, analogies, stories, and illustrations. When we reach the book's most difficult sections, I forewarn the reader and provide brief summaries for those who decide to skip or skim these more involved discussions. In this way, the reader should be able to walk the path of discovery and gain not just knowledge of physics' current worldview, but an understanding of how and why that worldview has gained prominence.

Students, avid readers of general-level science, teachers, and professionals should also find much of interest in the book. Although the initial chapters cover the necessary but standard background material in relativity and quantum mechanics, the focus on the corporeality of space and time is somewhat unconventional in its approach. Subsequent chapters cover a wide range of topics—Bell's theorem, delayed choice experiments, quantum measurement, accelerated expansion, the possibility of producing black holes in the next generation of particle accelerators, fanciful wormhole time machines, to name a few—and so will bring such readers up to date on a number of the most tantalizing and debated advances.

Some of the material I cover is controversial. For those issues that remain up in the air, I've discussed the leading viewpoints in the main text. For the points of contention that I feel have achieved more of a consensus, I've relegated differing viewpoints to the notes. Some scientists, especially those holding minority views, may take exception to some of my judgments, but through the main text and the notes, I've striven for a balanced treatment. In the notes, the particularly diligent reader will also find more complete explanations, clarifications, and caveats relevant to points I've simplified, as well as (for those so inclined) brief mathematical counterparts to the equation-free approach